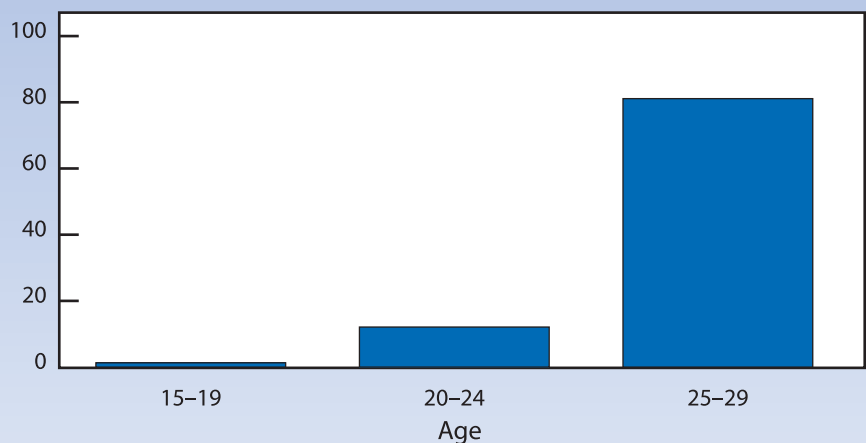


STAT BITE

Breast Cancer in Young U.S. Women

Breast cancer in girls and young women is often more advanced and aggressive than when diagnosed in an older population. It accounts for 5% of cancers in adolescents and young adults in the United States but for less than 0.1% of overall breast cancer cases. The total incidence for women in this age group in 2000 was 90 cases per million, compared with over 1,300 cases per million in the general population. Breast cancer incidence for women ages 15 to 29 remained stable between 1975 and 2000, with the highest incidence in 25- to 29-year-olds and African American women ages 10 to 34. Research suggests that a family history of breast cancer is the primary risk factor in this age group.

Average breast cancer incidence per million in women under age 30 by age group, 1975–2000:



Citation: *Cancer Epidemiology in Older Adolescents and Young Adults 15 to 29 Years of Age, Including SEER Incidence and Survival: 1975–2000*. National Cancer Institute, NIH Pub. No. 06-5767, Bethesda, MD 2006. Available at: http://seer.cancer.gov/publications/aya/aya_errata_figures.pdf.

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